B1 Listening

Understanding announcements

Catch the key facts in station and airport announcements: times, numbers, places and changes.

Announcements are fast and you usually hear them only once. You do not need every word. Before you listen, decide what you need: a platform, a gate, a time or a delay.

Listen for	Typical words
Changes	*delayed, cancelled, now departing from, instead of*
Places	*platform 4, gate B12, the main entrance*
Times	*at 10:45, in about 20 minutes, until further notice*
Instructions	*please make your way to, have your boarding pass ready*

Listen

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Good morning, ladies and gentlemen. This is an announcement for passengers travelling on the 10:15 train to Manchester. This train is running about twenty minutes late and will now depart from platform 6, not platform 4. We apologise for the delay. Passengers for Leeds, please note that the 10:30 service has been cancelled. The next train to Leeds will leave at 11 o'clock from platform 2. Thank you.

Numbers that sound alike. Listen carefully to *-teen* and *-ty*: *fifteen* has the stress at the end, *fifty* at the start.

Common mistake. Stopping at the first number you hear. Announcements often give the old information first and the new information after *now* or *instead*.

Practice

1. Where is the Manchester train going?
2. About how late is the Manchester train?
3. Which platform will it leave from now?
4. What has happened to the 10:30 train to Leeds?
5. What time is the next train to Leeds?
6. Which platform does it leave from?

▼ **Show answers**

1. To Manchester (the 10:15 service)
2. About twenty minutes
3. Platform 6
4. It has been cancelled.
5. 11 o'clock
6. Platform 2